The Complicated Problem of Closing Open Data

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Where It All Began

A decade old, like many government data portals

Emphasis so far on participation and publishing

Appraisal and selection left to individual agencies

Good News, Bad News

Good: The portal is established, more data is open to the public, and use is accelerating.

Bad: Aging junk -- practice datasets, empty datasets, obsolete and low/no-use data.

Discovery gets harder. Keeping everything means the noise-to-signal ratio of searches will be high.

(Whyte & Wilson, 2010)

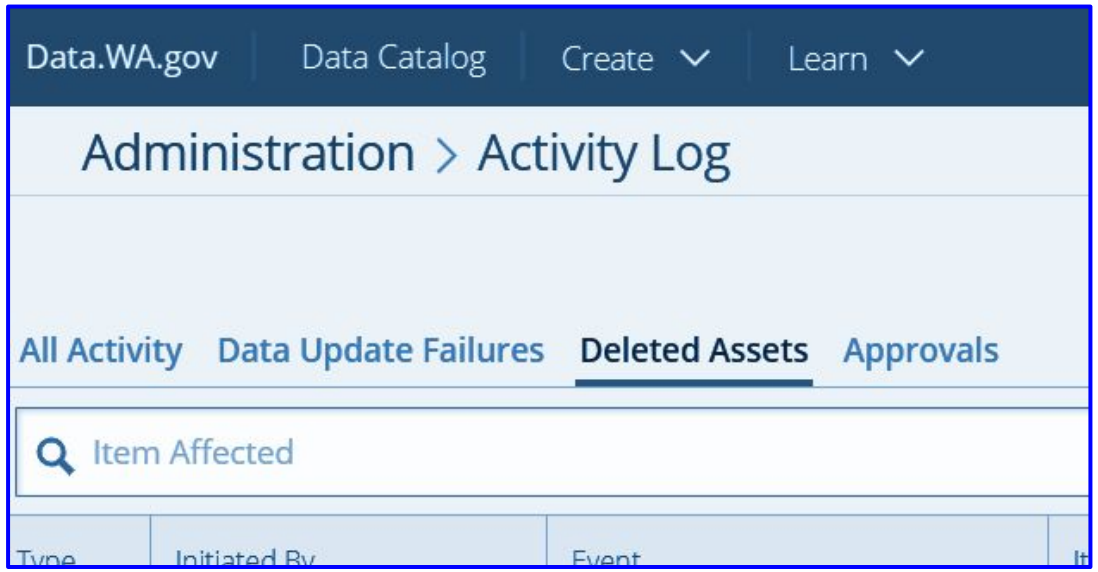
A partnership is born: OCIO + State Library

Libraries manage, prune collections

OCIO contracted with the Library to provide curation services -- prune “low-quality” data, better document and promote the rest, and support data quality going forward.

As a library intern, Andrew came in to conduct an initial assessment, but quickly recognized a snag …

How do you close open data (the right way)?



How do you un-select what was never (centrally) selected?

What is “low quality” data – inaccurate? obsolete? poorly documented? superseded?

How do you remove data in the spirit of transparency, access and public interest?

Time to Research: What We Did

B	C	D	E
State	**URL**	**Date Visited**	**platform/source**
Connecticut	https://www.osc.ct.g	20200113	Socrata
Connecticut	https://data.ct.gov/	20200120	Socrata
Delaware	https://data.delawar	20200122	Socrata
Delaware	https://firstmap-dela	20200122	Esri
District of Columbia	https://opendata.dc.	20200122	Esri
Florida	http://geodata.myflc	20200124	Esri

Looked for data removal policies or practices at **other state government data portals**

Consulted **other domains** (e.g., archives, depositories) for weeding models

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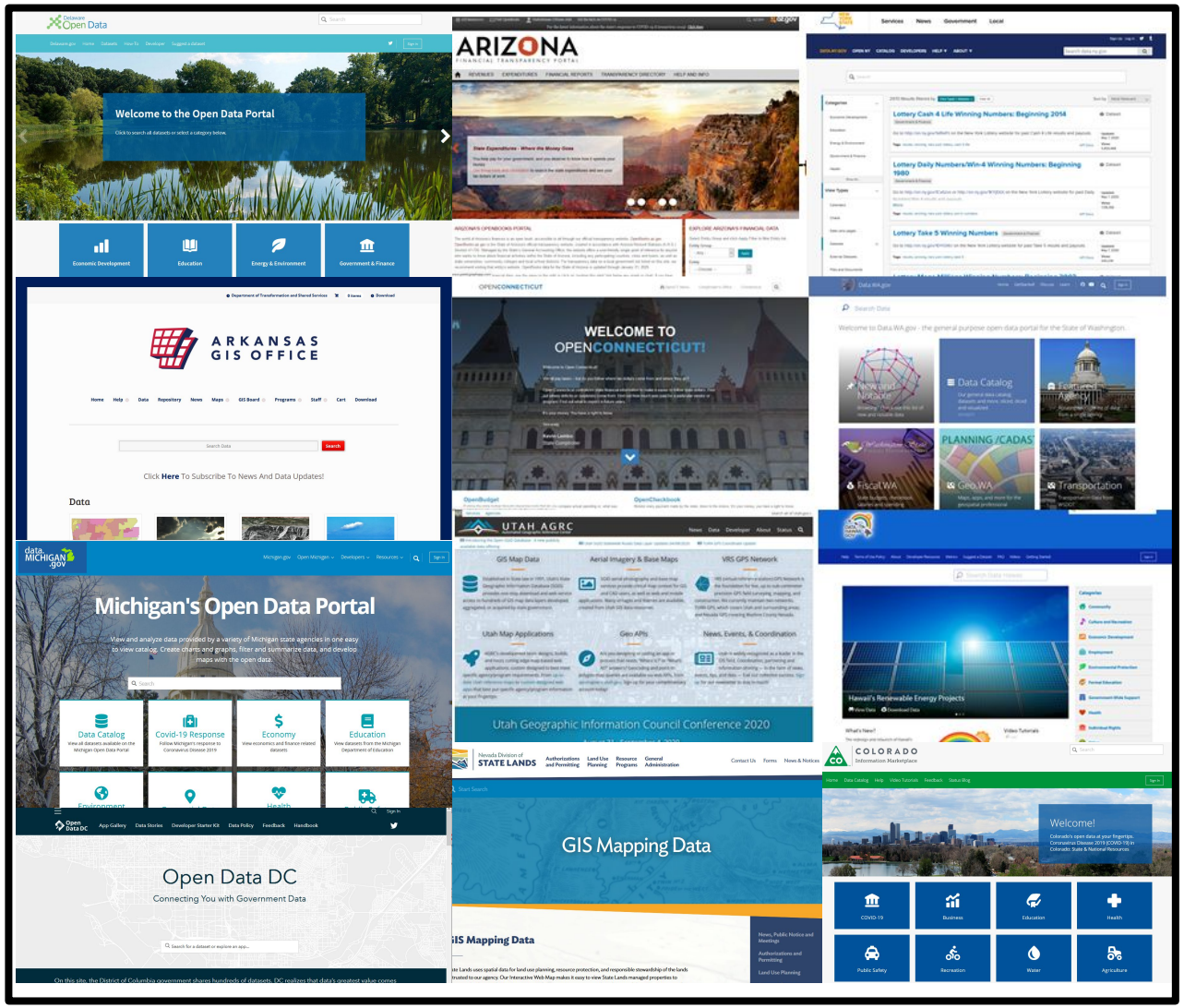
Portal Assessment

- 91 sites, 50 States:
  - 49 geospatial only
  - 13 transparency
  - 24 make tabular data available
  - 5 are other ‘open gov’ sites
- Sent 53 emails, 29 responses



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data.ok.gov

search

About Datasets Snapshots

Home / Dataset

Type

Dataset

Categories

- Finance and Administration (100)
- Economic Development (46)
- Education (37)
- Health (35)
- Public Safety and Defense (19)
- Demographics (16)
- Natural Resources (11)
- Technology (11)
- Local Government (5)
- Social Services (4)
- Regulatory Services (3)
- Transportation (3)
- Other (2)
- Tourism And Recreation (1)

Topics

- economy (38)

Search

Search results

State-Managed Buildings Energy Savings Impact Dataset

Data reflecting the total energy saved in all state-managed buildings. Finance and Administration state buildings energy usage energy savings Field Value publisher-name data.ok.gov harvest_object_id 2ffz-i3xx harvest_source_id data.ok.gov harvest_last_upd

State Employee Turnover Rate Dataset

Maintain the state employee turnover rate at or below the annual regional average of surrounding states every year through 2019. Finance and Administration government state employee state personnel turnover Field Value publisher-name State of Oklahoma har

School Counselor- Student Ratio Dataset

Increase the school counselor to student ratio from 1 counselor per 421 students in 2013 to 1 counselor per 250 students by 2018. Education counselor school student ratio Field Value publisher-name data.ok.gov harvest_object_id 2jsz-jc8z harvest_source_id

Health Care Cost Growth Dataset

Limit state-purchased health care cost growth to 2% less than the projected national health expenditures average every year through 2019. Health healthcare health care cost growth Field Value publisher-name data.ok.gov harvest_object_id 2rx6-rfwj harvest_

AP Support Program (AVID) Dataset

Increase the percentage of public school districts participating in the Advanced Placement (AP) support program (AVID) from 3% in 2014 to 7% by 2018. Education ap advanced placement support program avid Field Value publisher-name data.ok.gov harvest_objec

Search

Categories

- Agriculture
- Consumer Protection
- Culture and Community
- Demographics
- Economics

Show All...

View Types

- Calendars
- Charts
- Data Lens pages
- Datasets
- External Datasets
- Files and Documents
- Filtered Views
- Forms
- Maps

Washington State Open Data

2879 Results

Sort by Most Relevant

Health Care Provider Credential Data

Health

Dataset

The Washington State Department of Health presents this information as a service to the public. True and correct copies of legal disciplinary actions taken after July 1998 are available on our Provider Credential Search site. These

More

Tags credential, provider, care, public, health, and 3 more

API Docs

Updated
May 10, 2020

Views
1,263,909

Elliot Bay

Natural Resources & Environment

Map

This is a map of cleanup sites and associated websites.

More

Tags ecology, cleanup status, cleanup, toxics cleanup, warm ranking, and 2 more

Updated
July 23, 2019

Views
216,436

Kenmore waterfront

Natural Resources & Environment

Map

This is a map of cleanup sites and associated websites.

More

Tags ecology, cleanup status, cleanup, toxics cleanup, warm ranking, and 2 more

Updated
July 23, 2019

Views
215,955

Find a Health Provider Credential

Health

Data Lens

This "data lens" page allows you to search the Department of Health's provider credential database for a specific

Updated

Few Policies Exist - Six States

5 List criteria

5 Publish procedures

4 Label retired datasets

3 Use waiting periods

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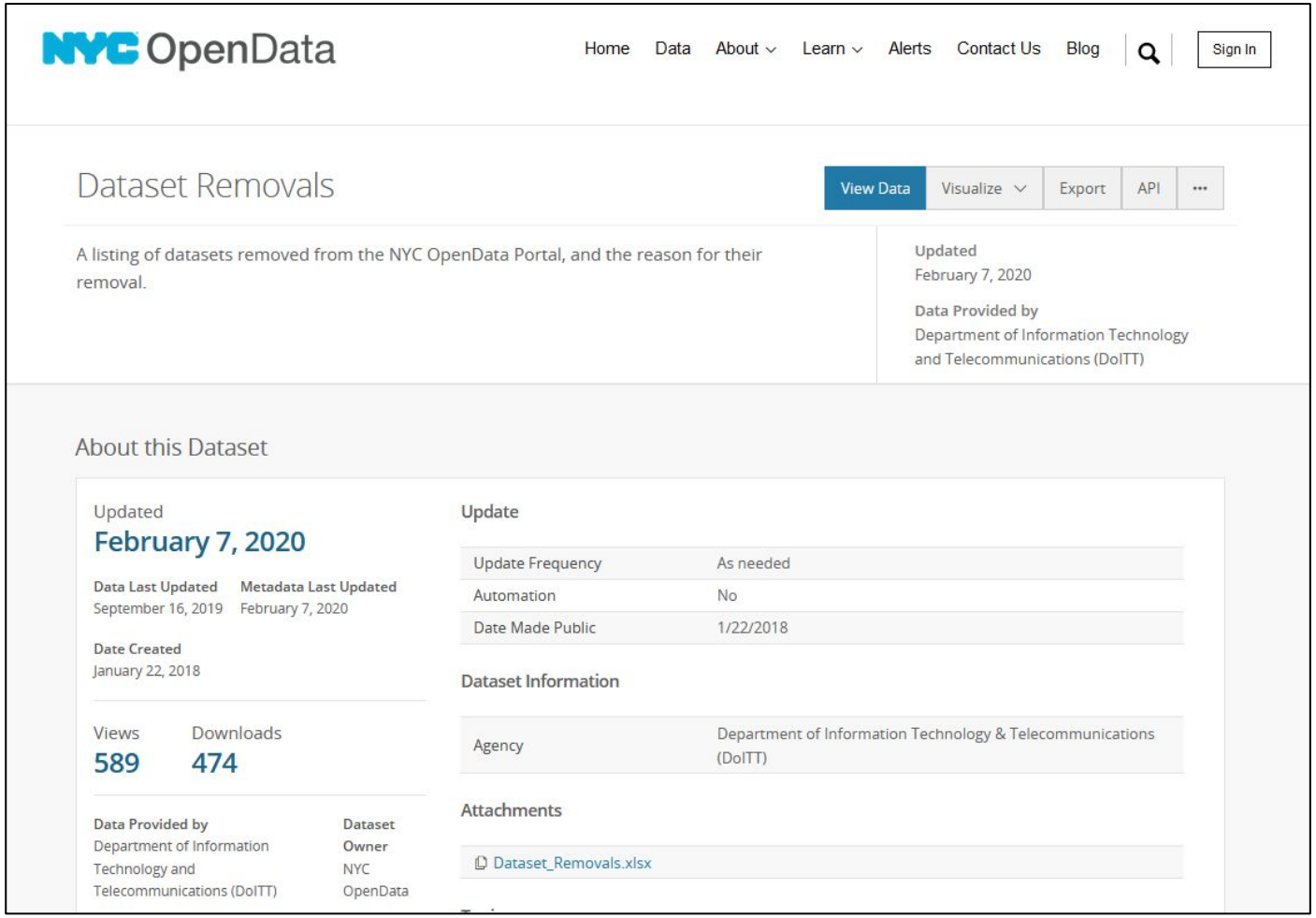
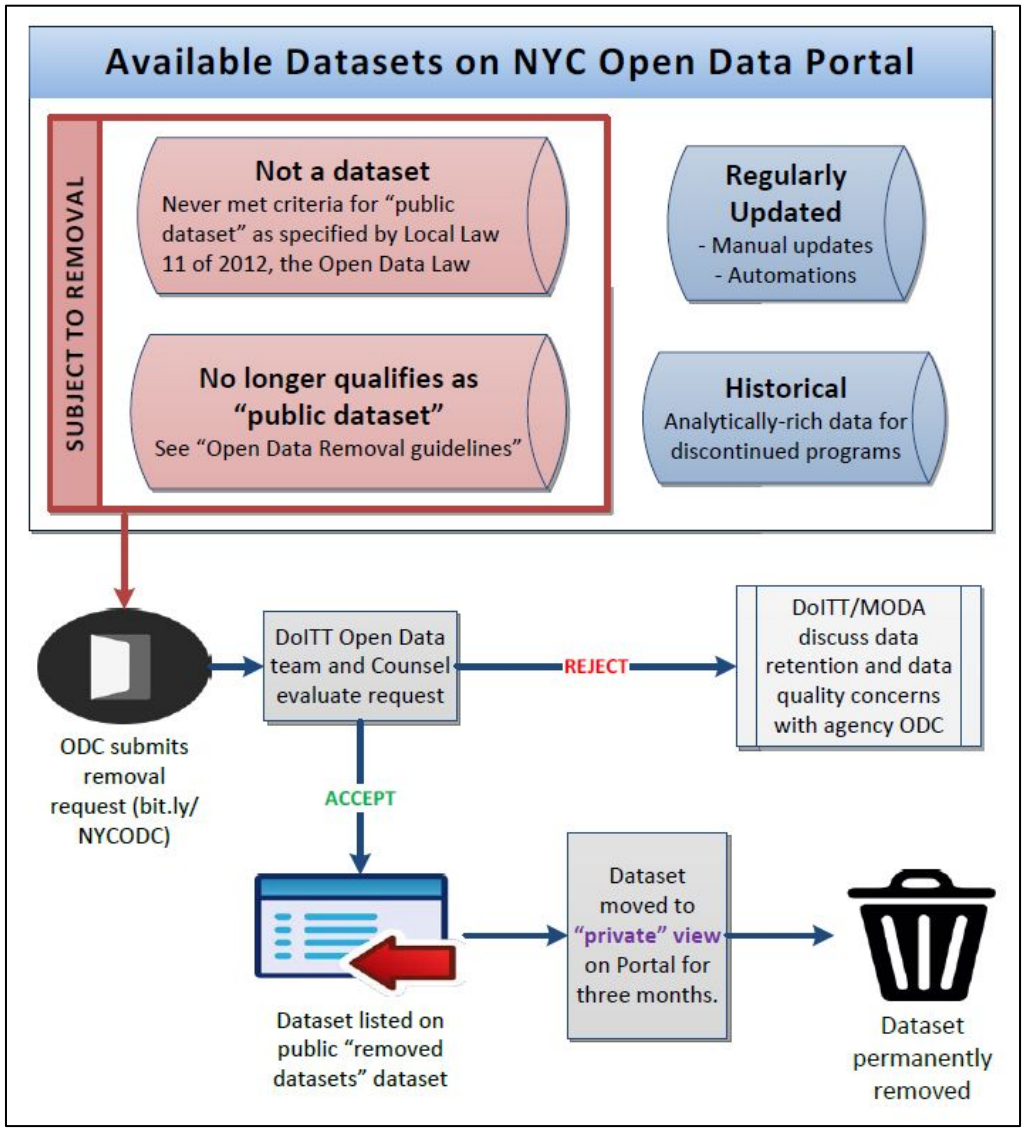
There is One Great Example





https://opendata.cityofnewyork.us/wp-content/uploads/2018/01/Open-Data-Removals-Process-and-Guidelines.pdf

Removal and Retirement is Occurring

125 Results

ARCHIVED - RCCL 4.1 Administered Exams FY08- FY17 Social Services

Residential Child Care Licensing (RCCL) was transferred from DFPS to HHSC September 1, 2018. This data set includes Fiscal Years 2008-2017 only. Check with HHSC for more recent data.
More

Tags data book, databook, licensing, residential, exams, and 4 more

ARCHIVED - DCL 3.5 Adverse Actions by Operation Type and County FY08-FY17
Social Services

Day Care Licensing (DCL) was transferred from DFPS to HHSC September 1, 2018. This data set includes Fiscal 2008-2017 only. Check with HHSC for more recent data.
More

Tags oidb, data book, databook, licensing, day care, and 6 more

Data

ARCHIVE - Ohio EMA Watch Office - May 28 Activation - Final Tornado Tracks from NWS
Ohio Emergency Management Agency | emawatch

Type: KML
Last Updated: June 26, 2019
Tags: tornad

2006 Chapter 18 Article 15: Blasting
+ File or Documer

Regulatory Codes
Data Provided by data.kcmo.org

Older Archived 2006 Building and Rehabilitation Code

Tags blasting, ordinances, codes

Updated
September 24, 2014
Views
68

Beaches Archived Data Natural Resources
Dataset

Tags beach ecoli status
API Docs

Updated
February 15, 2019
Views
160

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Some things we noticed

- Difficult to understand who runs a portal
- Some portals are faceless

Photo by Fletcher6 - Own Work CC BY-SA 3.0

Data Provided by	**Dataset Owner**
(none)	Open Data Portal Kung-Fu Master

Subject: Re: A response was submitted through the form 'Contact Form'

Hello Kathleen,

Thank you for using [*state data portal*]. At this point we don't have policy/procedure for removing datasets. If any dataset needs to be removed, it will be decided by individual agency.

If we get more info, will keep you posted.

Thanks
[*state data portal*] Administrator

Portals with People, Policies

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- open.data@dc.gov

Learn More

- DC Government Data Policy
- DC Government Open Data Handbook
- Data Terms of Use
- DC's ArcGIS Online Organization
- District of Columbia GIS
- Meet our Chief Data Officer
- Interagency Data Team

Delaware.gov
The Official Website of the First State

Search for Services, People and More...

Featured

Delaware First Map – A repository of geospatial data about Delaware. This is data expressed in a form that can be mapped and compared to other geographic information.

Delaware Open Data Council - The Council is charged with recommending standards and policies related to a statewide open data strategy.

Open Data Portal

Maryland.gov Council on Open Data

Retirement/Removal Models

Archival Record?

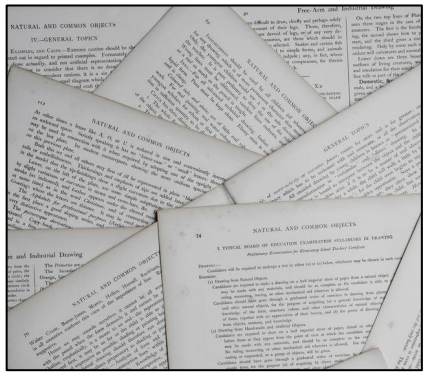


Photo by Annie Spratt on Unsplash

Government Document with Retention Schedule?

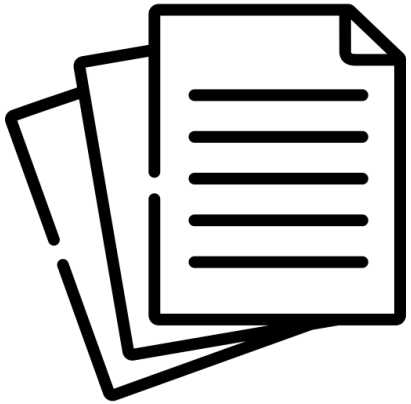
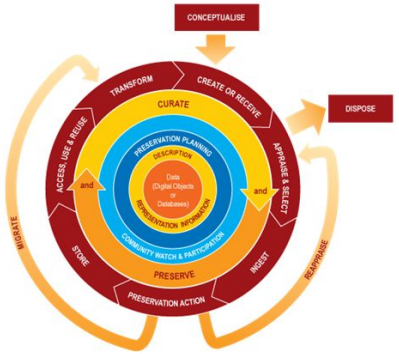


Image by Freepik on Flaticon

Resource in a Research Data Library?



Data Curation Centre

Resource in Traditional Library?

Photo by Rabie Madaci on Unsplash

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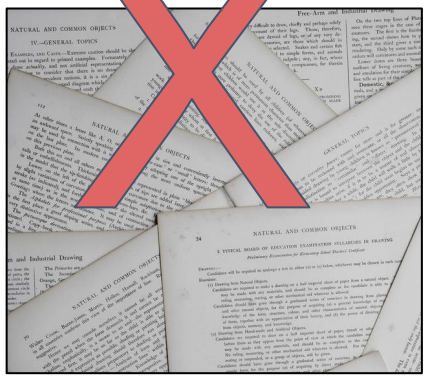
Retirement/Removal Models

Archival Record?



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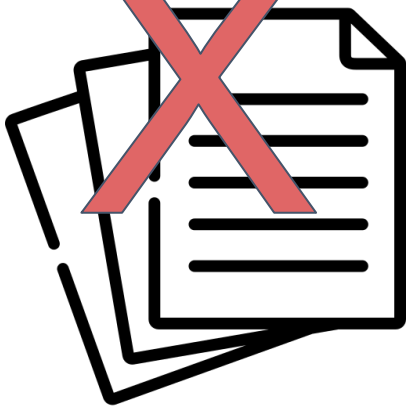

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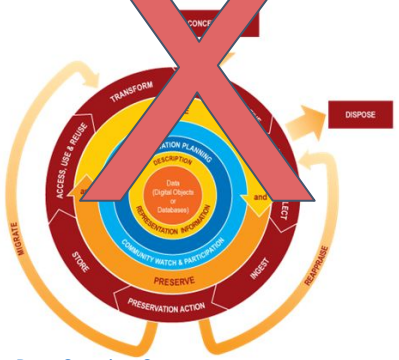

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Resource in Traditional Library?

Photo by Rabie Madaci on Unsplash

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Recommendations for data.wa.gov

Work with publishers and users on...

Appraisal and Selection Policy

Broad goals that work in a decentralized environment

Retirement Policy

Clear criteria
Procedures
Labeling

Connect with Digital Archives

about preserving historically valuable data

Make Portal Personable

Make policies and people easy to find

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Questions?

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